

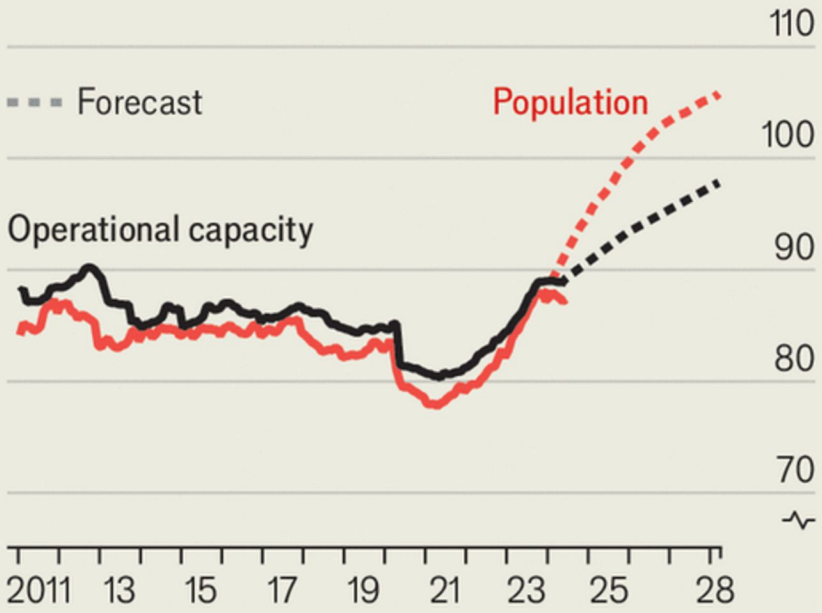
How Sports England got your phone nicked

The rather bizarre tale of Britain's prison capacity crisis



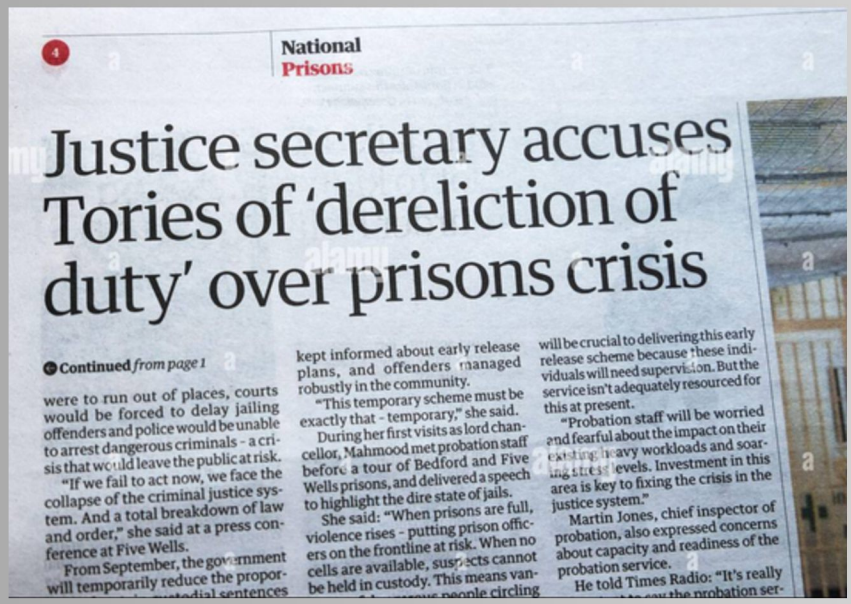
Prison breaks

England and Wales, prison population and capacity, '000



Sources: Ministry of Justice; Institute for Government

Did the pollies forget?



National
Prisons

Justice secretary accuses Tories of 'dereliction of duty' over prisons crisis

Continued *from page 1*

were to run out of places, courts would be forced to delay jailing offenders and police would be unable to arrest dangerous criminals - a crisis that would leave the public at risk.

"If we fail to act now, we face the collapse of the criminal justice system. And a total breakdown of law and order," she said at a press conference at Five Wells.

From September, the government will temporarily reduce the proportion of custodial sentences kept informed about early release plans, and offenders managed robustly in the community.

"This temporary scheme must be exactly that - temporary," she said.

During her first visits as lord chancellor, Mahmood met probation staff before a tour of Bedford and Five Wells prisons, and delivered a speech to highlight the dire state of jails.

She said: "When prisons are full, violence rises - putting prison officers on the frontline at risk. When no cells are available, suspects cannot be held in custody. This means vanpeople circling will be crucial to delivering this early release scheme because these individuals will need supervision. But the service isn't adequately resourced for this at present.

"Probation staff will be worried and fearful about the impact on their existing heavy workloads and soaring stress levels. Investment in this area is key to fixing the crisis in the justice system."

Martin Jones, chief inspector of probation, also expressed concerns about capacity and readiness of the probation service.

He told Times Radio: "It's really



Feast

Inside Feast magazine

The Guardian

News provider of the year

'Disgraceful' failures of Tories led to jails crisis

How to see plays & gigs for free → Saturday

Supplements the doctors swear by → Saturday

Rajeev Sya... Home affairs editor

Rishi Sunak and his former ministers are "the guilty men" who should be held responsible for "the most disgraceful dereliction of duty" by the lord chancellor has said.

As she set out plans to release thousands of prisoners early to ease

threatened with a total breakdown of law and order".

Writing exclusively in the Guardian, Keir Starmer underlined the severity of the problem. He said his first week in office had made clear to him that the Tories had been "arrogant, reckless and irresponsible to the very end ... they'll go down in history as the government that fiddled while the country burned".

The prime minister's criticism came as Mahmood set out emergency measures to prevent the prison system from reaching the point of collapse. In a speech at HMP Five Wells in Wellingborough, Northamptonshire, the justice secretary said jails had been operating at 99% capacity since the start of 2023.

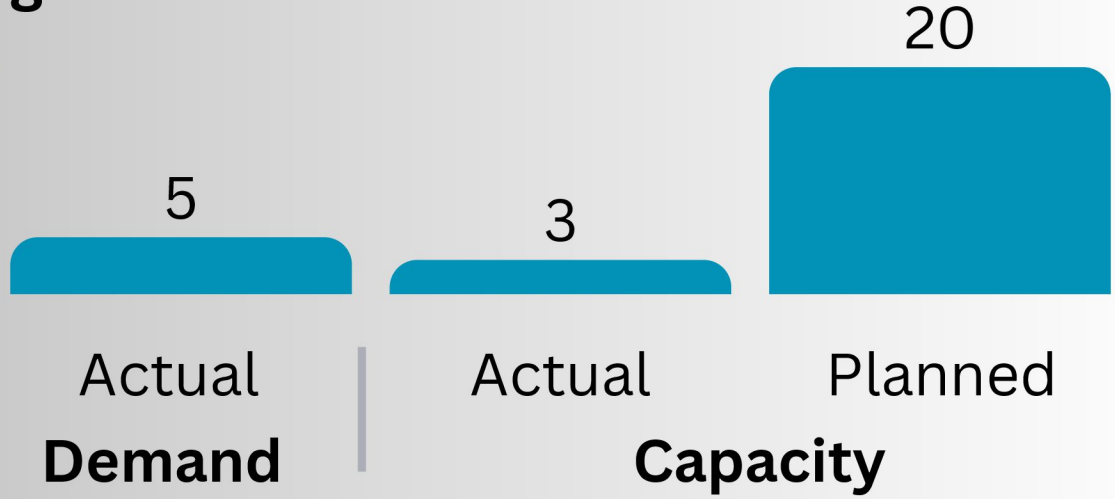
"Those responsible – Sunak and [illegible] who put their political careers ahead of the safety and security of our country. It was the most disgraceful dereliction of duty I have ever known.

"Time and again, they ducked the difficult decisions that could have addressed this challenge. Instead, they kept the public in the dark about the state they had left this country in," she said.

Thousands of prisoners will be released under the new scheme after they have served 40% of their sentences. The government will also recruit 1,000 probation officers to solve an overcrowding crisis that threatens "a total breakdown of law and order", the justice secretary has announced.

Mahmood described the policy as "the only way to avert [illegible] disaster", saying if prisons

Nope. We planned, we just didn't deliver!







HMP Five Wells

or

"Inside HMP Woke"

Daily Mail







HMP Five Wells

or

"Inside HMP Woke"

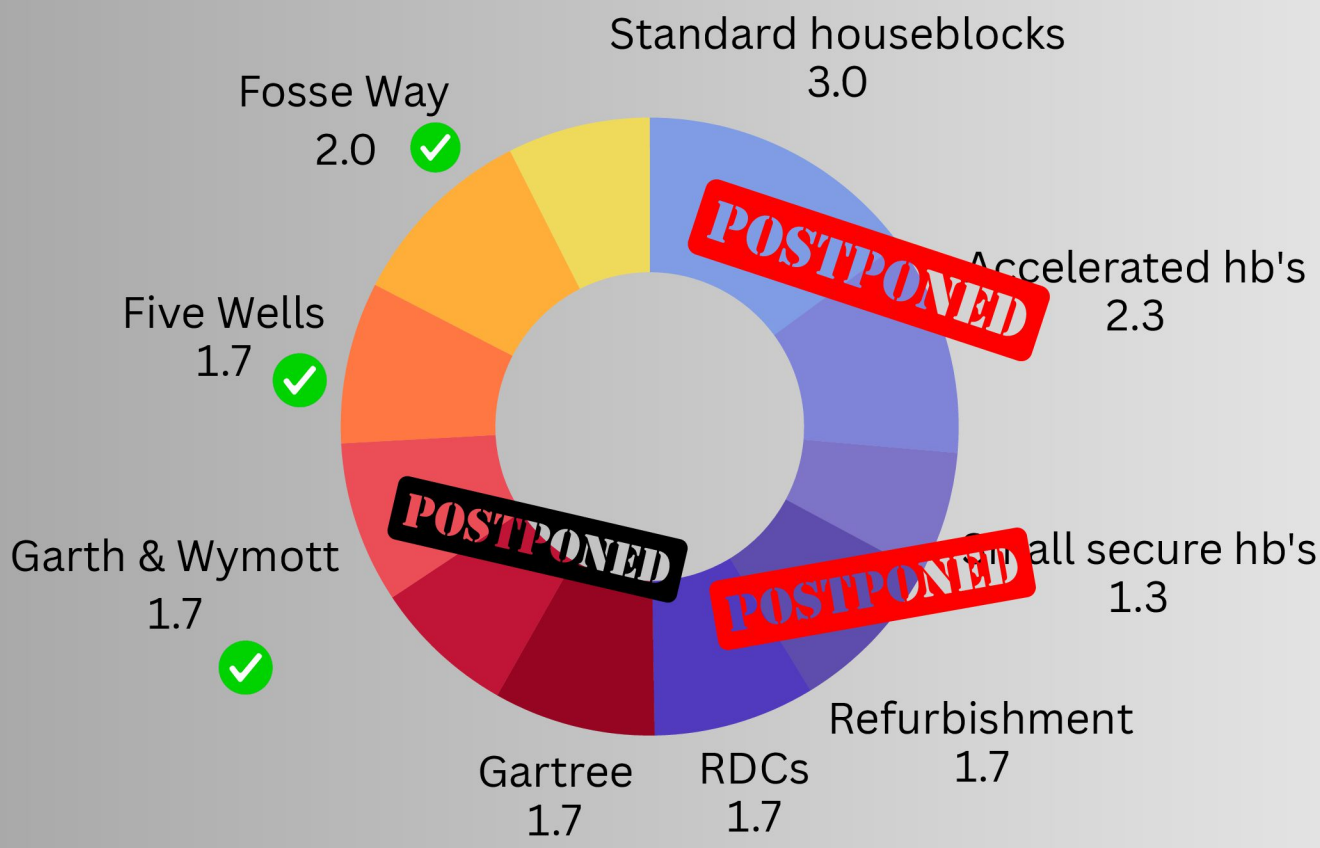
Daily Mail



Our system stopped it

What we tried to do

New Prisons: 10k cells **Blocks etc: 10k cells**



Why?

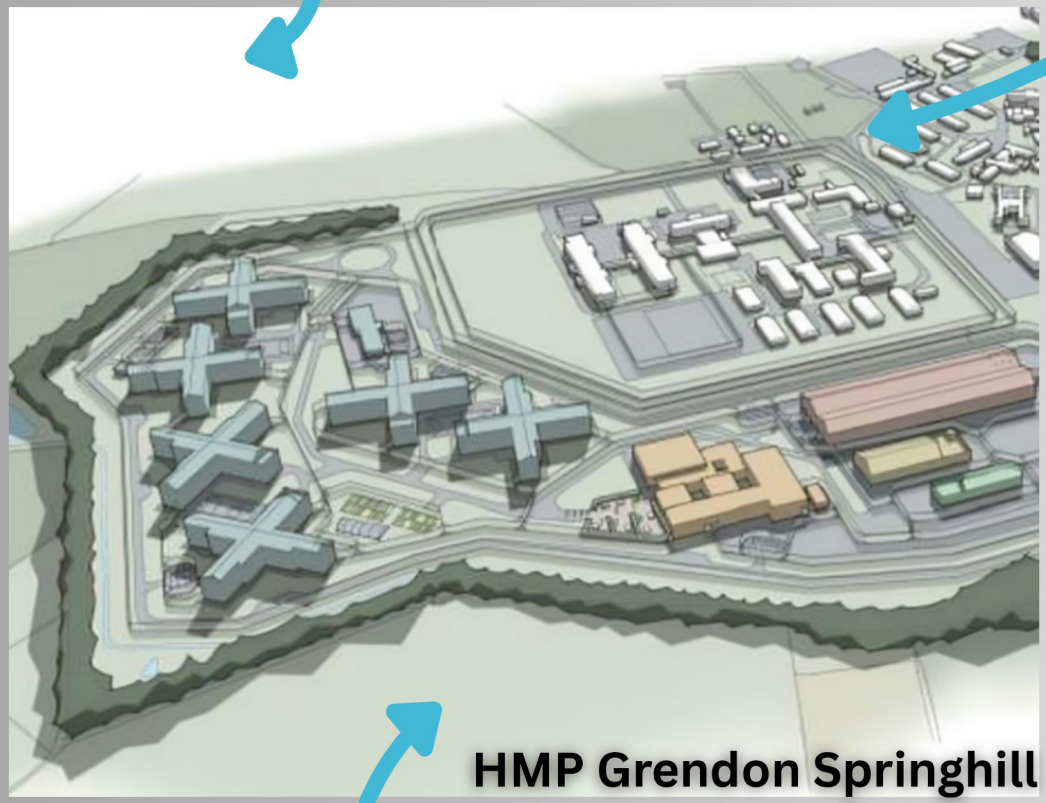
- Batty local objections
- Bowling greens
- Bats, butterflies, and badgers
- Buffer strips & backlogs

REJECTED

“landscape & visual impact”

FIELDS

EXISTING PRISONS





MORE FIELDS

FIELDS

“Unsustainable location”

because no public transport

REJECTED

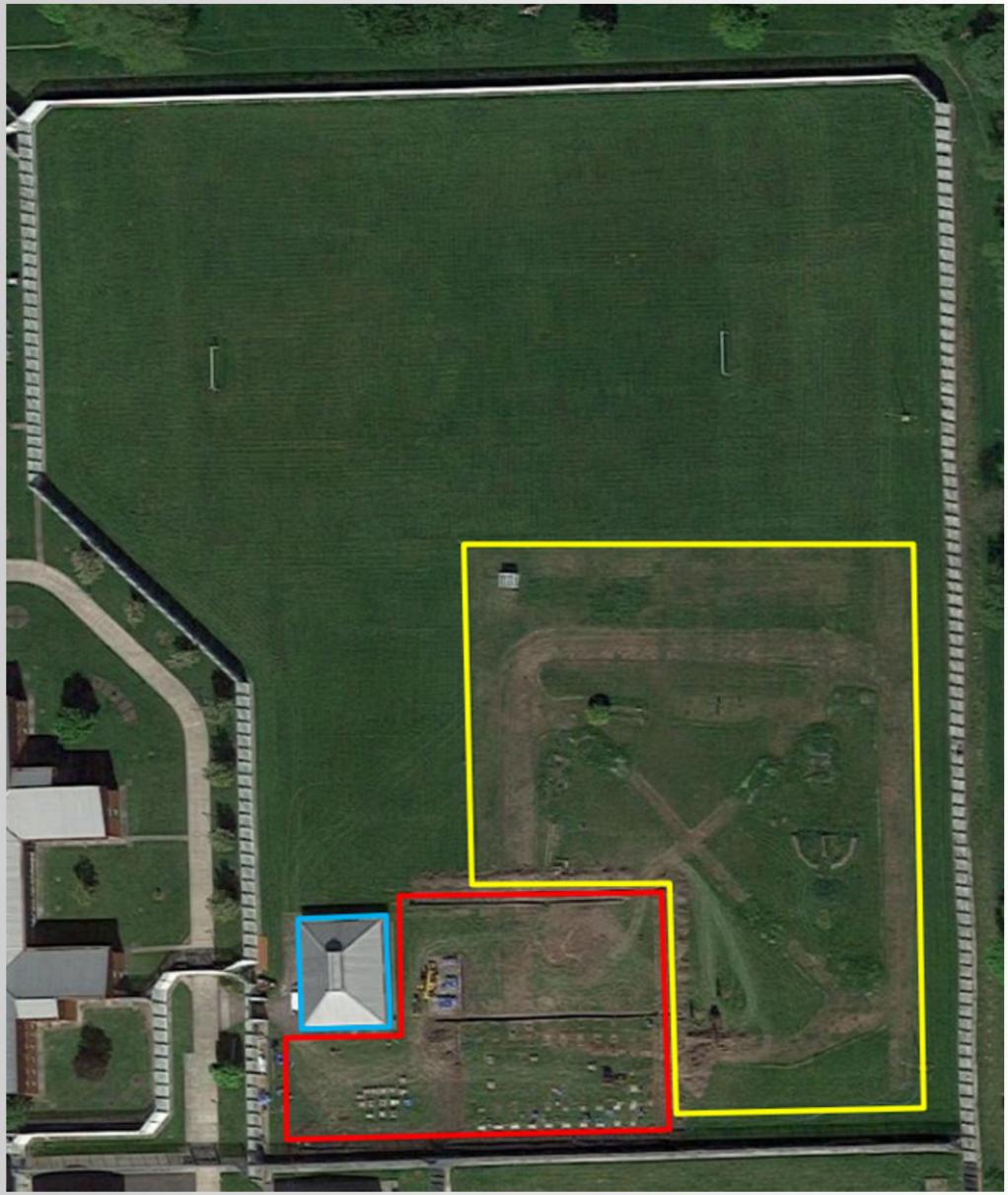


BUS STOP

SIGN THAT SAYS
“PRISON IS HERE”

Field is:

- Out of use
- Flood zone
- Poor drainage
- Only usable certain times of the year
- Security risk for throwovers



SPORT ENGLAND

“The lack of use of the playing field has no bearing on it’s lawful use.”



“Designed to be smuggled into prisons… hmm, nope, it is a dinky novelty.”

★★★☆☆

MarmiteMan





"the Wymott Bowling Club will be demolished..."



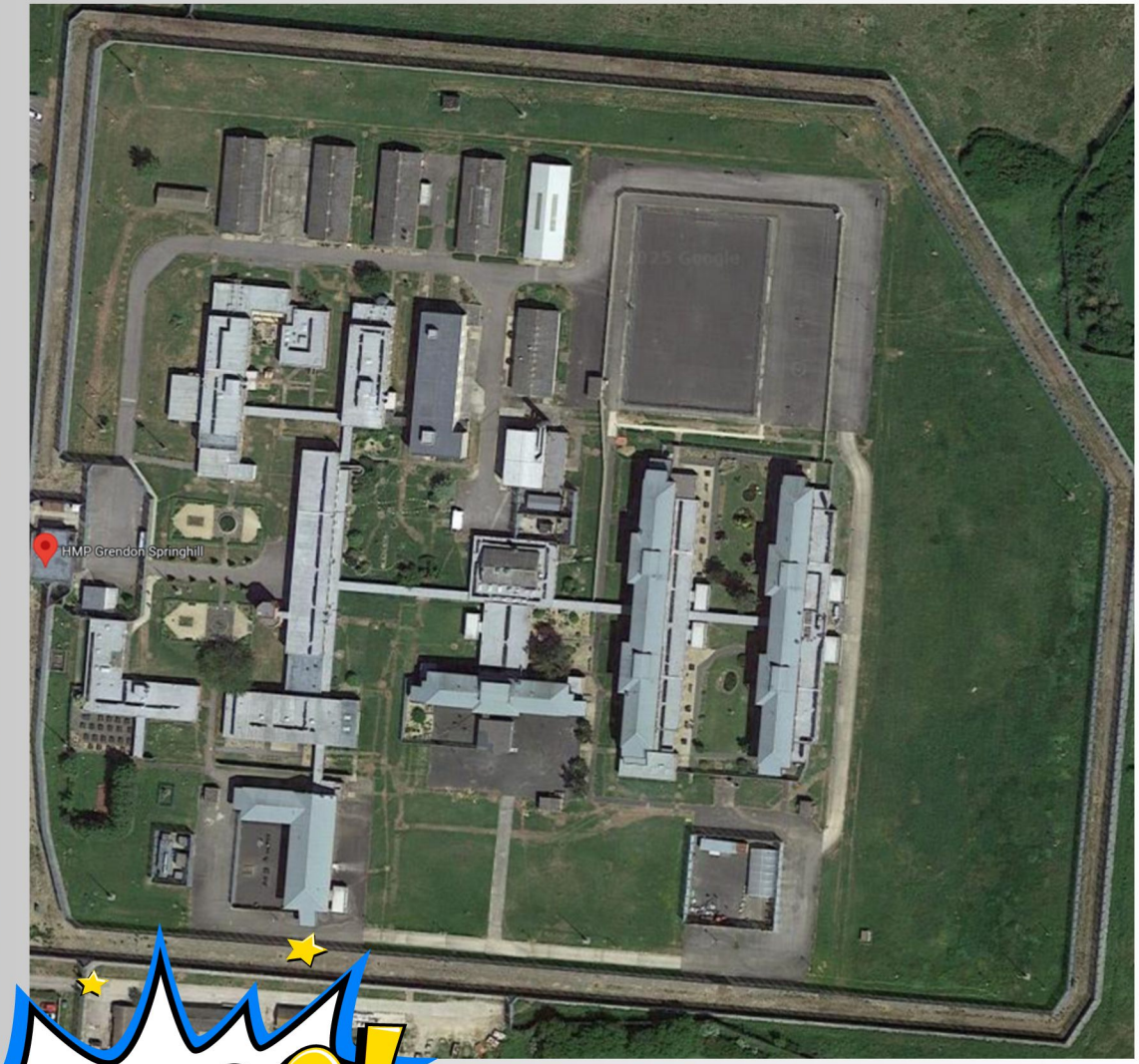


"A detailed specification by a qualified sports turf agronomist is required for the for construction of the new bowling green"

SPORT ENGLAND



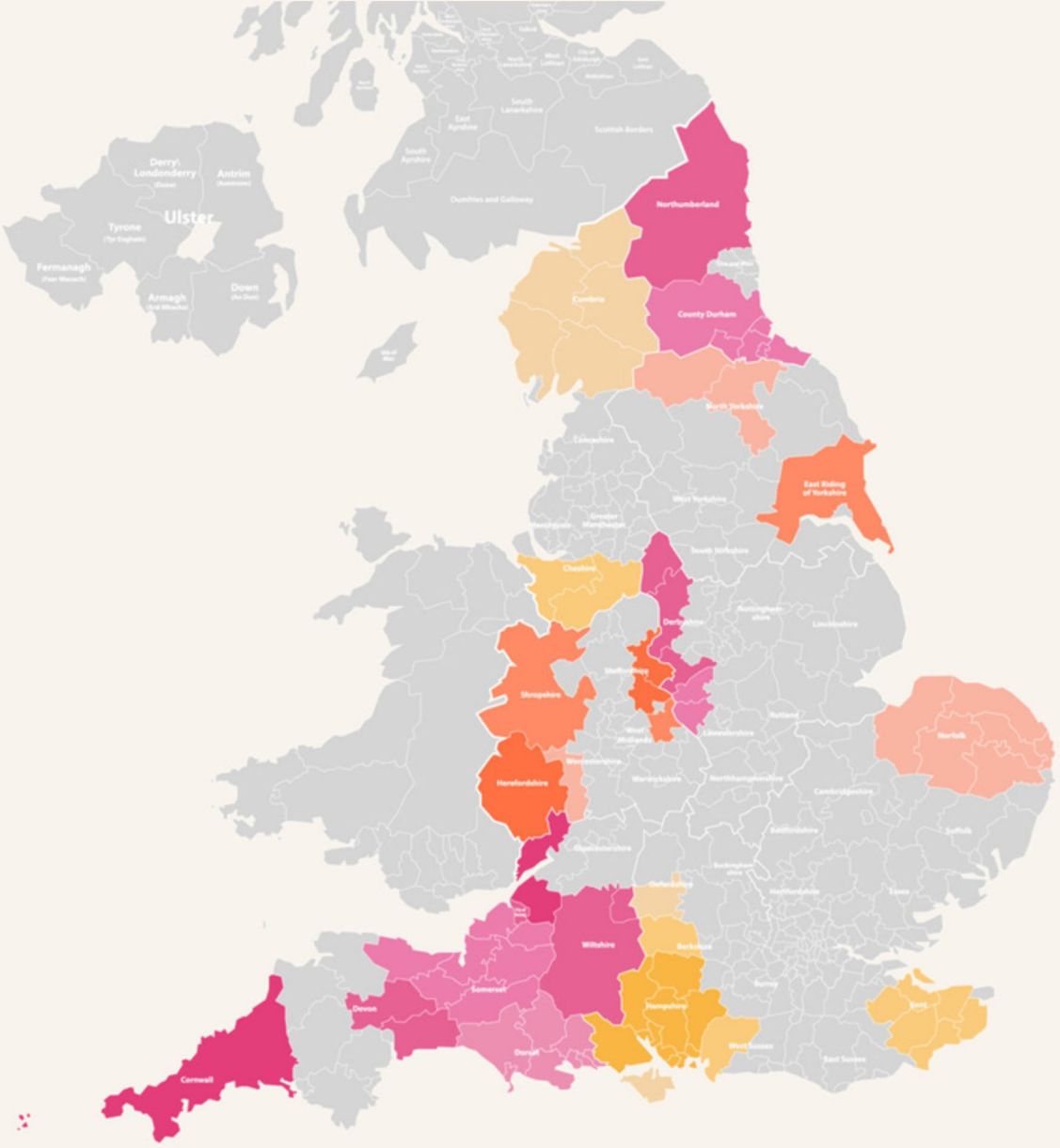




BINGO!







Nutrient Neutrality

Bespoke mitigation plans

Mitigation credit schemes not ready

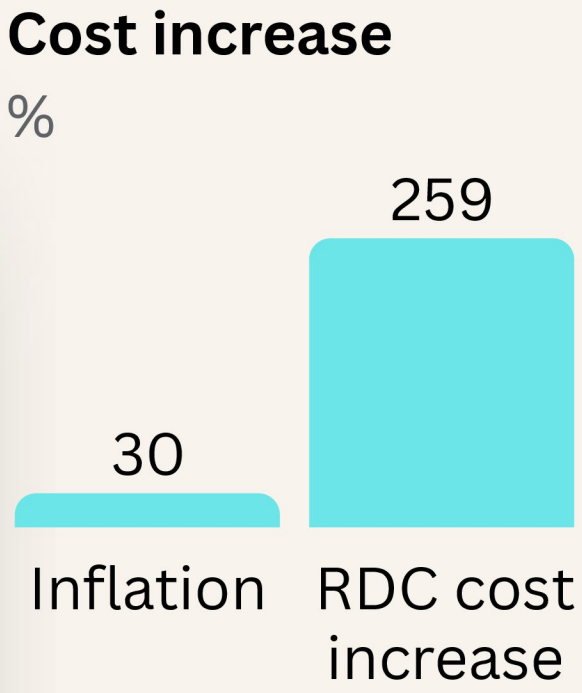
Delays at Nature England

80-120k homes stalled

£47m scheme to unblock own scheme

“Rapid” deployment cells







This shouldn’t be listed

So it must be these guys then?







The programme was part of the **government's 'Project Speed' initiative** to fast-track infrastructure projects… but, **when risks materialised, they proved difficult to unblock.**

This isn’t good enough





We cannot hope for the best but do nothing differently